Unit 8 — Science and Society

Track E · Klasse 10 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can read a short popular-science article and identify the main finding and one limitation.*
- *I can use vocabulary of scientific reasoning (*hypothesis, control group, sample size, peer review*).*
- *I can write a 220-word science-and-society reflection.*

Lead-in I

Maja read a popular-science article about a four-day school week trial in a small Belgian district. Test scores were unchanged. Pupil well-being scores were higher. Cost savings were real. *And the catch?* Maja wrote in the margin. Two paragraphs later: *the Friday childcare problem*.

Vocabulary I

- hypothesis
- variable
- control group
- sample size
- peer review
- replication
- statistical significance
- confidence interval
- limitation
- scaling
- generalisability

Reading I

Reading — *Four Days, Five Lessons*
A two-year trial of a four-day school week in a small Belgian district found test scores unchanged, pupil well-being scores higher, and modest cost savings. The trial included 14 schools, with a matched control group of 14 nearby schools. The results were peer-reviewed and published in 2027. The study notes one important limitation: many families struggled to arrange childcare for the extra Friday, and the burden fell unevenly on lower-income parents. The authors caution against scaling up before this is solved.

Vocabulary — scientific reasoning
hypothesis, variable, control group, sample size, peer review, replication, statistical significance,

Reading II

confidence interval, limitation, scaling, generalisability.

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Match: control group → comparison; peer review → expert check; replication → re-running. (T / F)
2. T or F from text: 14 trial schools, 14 control schools, peer-reviewed, no limitations.

Niveau E — productive

3. Build 4 sentences using science-of-evidence vocabulary about the four-day school week trial.

Your turn I

Reflection, 220 words. Take a position on whether you would support a four-day school week trial in your area. Use 4 scientific-reasoning terms + 2 hedges + 1 *despite* / *given that*.

Sample

A two-year trial of a four-day school week in a small Belgian district found test scores unchanged, well-being higher, and modest cost savings. The trial included 14 schools and a matched control group. The results, peer-reviewed in 2027, are encouraging but specific to that context. The study notes one limitation that I take seriously: many families struggled to arrange childcare for the extra Friday, and the burden fell unevenly on lower-income parents. Given that the well-being gains depend on what happens on Friday, and not only on what happens Monday-to-Thursday,

Your turn II

scaling up before this is solved would risk turning a class-blind reform into a class-biased one. Despite my interest in the model, I would not support a trial in my area until two things are in place: a publicly-funded Friday childcare option, and a generalisability check — a second trial in a context closer to ours. The authors' caution is the right one. Replication and policy-design need to come together; otherwise we risk borrowing the result without the conditions that produced it.

Reflect I

- I can identify a main finding and one limitation in a popular-science article.
- I can use 6 scientific-reasoning terms.
- I can write a 220-word science-and-society reflection.

Further reading / listening I

- BBC Science Focus — accessible articles.
- Nature — *News & Views* short-form.